the theory relating to regionalism and regional integration.

Functionalism

As opposed to the sole concerns of the discipline of international relations with security and conflict studies, functionalism arose as an operative philosophy, which visualized a gradual evolution of a peaceful, unified and cooperative world. The earliest and influential exponent of functionalism was David Mitrany. His celebrated work *A Working Peace System* gives a clear exposition of his vision of building peace in the international system. Other proponents were Leonard Woolf, Norman Angell, Robert Cecil and G.D.H Cole. The functionalists do not aim at creating a world federal structure rather, they seek to build "peace by pieces", through transnational organizations, that emphasize the 'sharing of sovereignty', instead of its total surrender. It is a 'bottom up' approach for building cooperative links among states.

Beginning with the assumption that wars are the products of crudely organized international system, which is founded on suspicion, anarchy, sovereignty, and national exclusivism which, in turn, considers war as an accepted means of settling international disputes, functionalists opine that governments will not surrender their national interests and will not dismantle easily. Therefore, they prescribe a realistic means of attaining idealistic ends. They propose a gradual approach towards regional or global unity, which will aim to isolate and, at the end, will render obsolete the stubborn institutional structures of international system, the nation-states.

Functionalists lay emphasis on the socio-economic and welfare needs rather than on the political needs. Functionalism prescribes the development of piecemeal non-political cooperative organizations involving sectors such as economic, technical, scientific, social and cultural. These are regarded as the **functional sectors.** The basic calculation that works behind such assumption is that "it is easier to establish narrow-in-scope functional organizations (in sectors such as energy production and distribution, transportation and communications control, health protection and improvement, labour standards and exchanges and customs unions) than to develop grandiose political institutions that jeopardize the national